

A growing reputation

Macbeth (1886–1888) was the first of a series of brilliant orchestral tone poems that made Strauss's international reputation. "I've arrived," he exclaimed after the 1889 triumph of the sexually explicit Don Juan—in effect a condensed Wagner opera minus the voices. There was, by all accounts, more than a touch of wish fulfillment in his identification with the Don's amorous exploits, as well as in the idealized self-portrait of *Ein Heldenleben* (A Hero's Life).

From the mid-1880s, Strauss held a series of conducting posts in Munich, Weimar, and Berlin. In 1894, he married a former singing pupil, Pauline de Ahna, a general's daughter (who once said that Strauss was "anything but a Don Juan").

“ I employ **cacophony** to **outrage** people.
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RICHARD STRAUSS TO GUSTAV MAHLER